myTutor

From lecture file to second brain

MBAM601 Digital Experiment · Naw Aung · 81017125 · 28.10.2026

Problem: every teaching day brings about 10 slides, readings and cases. By hand, each one takes me about **9 minutes** to turn into Obsidian notes, and linking new ideas to old ones is the step I skip.

BASELINE
8.9 min
per file by hand: 44.5 min for 5 files

VOLUME
~10
sources per teaching day

QUALITY
70%
of manual notes passed all 5 structural checks (21 of 30)

USER
Me: an Executive MBA student building an Obsidian vault to keep after graduation

SCOPE
Slides, readings and cases → linked notes and a quiz. The theme journal stays manual

USER SIGNAL · N = 2, DIRECTIONAL
Two EMBA classmates already use AI for notes; both want answers that link back to their sources

AS-IS AND TO-BE

SAME SIX STEPS, THREE OF THEM NOW AUTOMATIC

#	AS-IS · every step by hand	TO-BE · myTutor, run by n8n
1	Save the file to OneDrive · me	Save the file to OneDrive · me
2	Pick concepts, paste into AI chat, retype the prompt · me · AI chat **slow, retyped**	Extract text, count words · Python **auto**
3	Copy each note out of the chat · me · AI chat **one by one**	Write notes, links, 5-question quiz · Claude API **auto**
4	Create, name and file each note · me · Obsidian **drifts**	File notes into the vault, log the run · Python **auto**
5	Link to the source and to old notes · me · Obsidian **often skipped**	Spot-check a 10-note sample, take the quiz · me
6	Write the theme journal · me (out of scope)	Write the theme journal · me (manual by design)

BOTTLENECKS

Steps 2–5 are manual hand-offs between three tools. The labelled ones cost the most time or quality; linking is skipped first.

WHAT CHANGES

n8n checks the folder every 15 minutes and runs steps 2–4 with no hand-offs. Notes are filed unattended; I then spot-check a 10-note sample.

KPIS AND BASELINE

FOUR KPIS, ALL MEASURED

KPI	Definition	Data source · cadence	Status
Time per source TARGET	(total minutes to filed and reviewed) ÷ (total words ÷ 1,000), from totals, not an average of per-file rates	Stopwatch log + run logs · every source	✓ measured
Note quality TARGET	notes passing all 5 structural checks ÷ notes created	Review tally, quality_audit.csv · every run, 10-note sample	✓ measured: structure; accuracy sampled once
Links per note GUARDRAIL	links to existing notes ÷ new notes	Obsidian link count, generate_runs.csv · every source	✓ measured
Recall GUARDRAIL	quiz score out of 5, 48 hours after the notes	Practice page, copied to my log · every source, +48 h	✓ measured once: 17/20 (4.25/5)

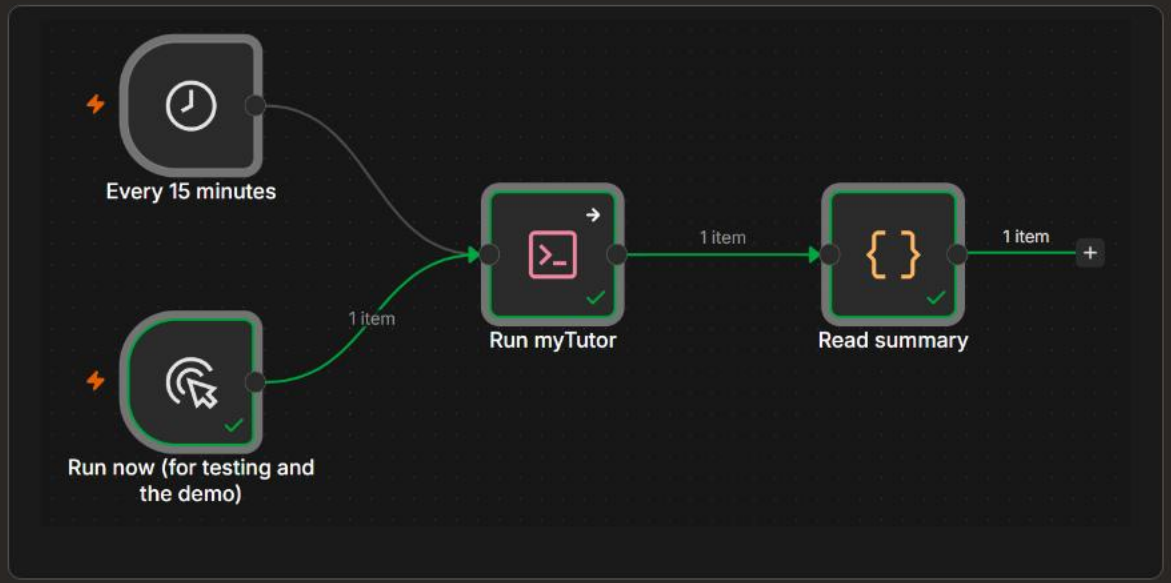
BASELINE METHOD · SAME 5 DAY 9 FILES, 15,212 WORDS

2 readings, 2 slide decks, 1 case · manual run first, then myTutor, notes kept apart · manual clock: open file → notes filed and linked · myTutor clock: logged run time + timed spot-check of every note · download and reading not timed (same both ways) · one tester, self-timed

BUILD

SAVE THE FILE; N8N RUNS THE REST

OneDrive I save the file › **n8n** every 15 min › **Python** retrieve, extract › **Claude API** notes, links, quiz › **Obsidian + logs** filed, run logged › **Practice page** offline quiz



PROOF OF RUNS

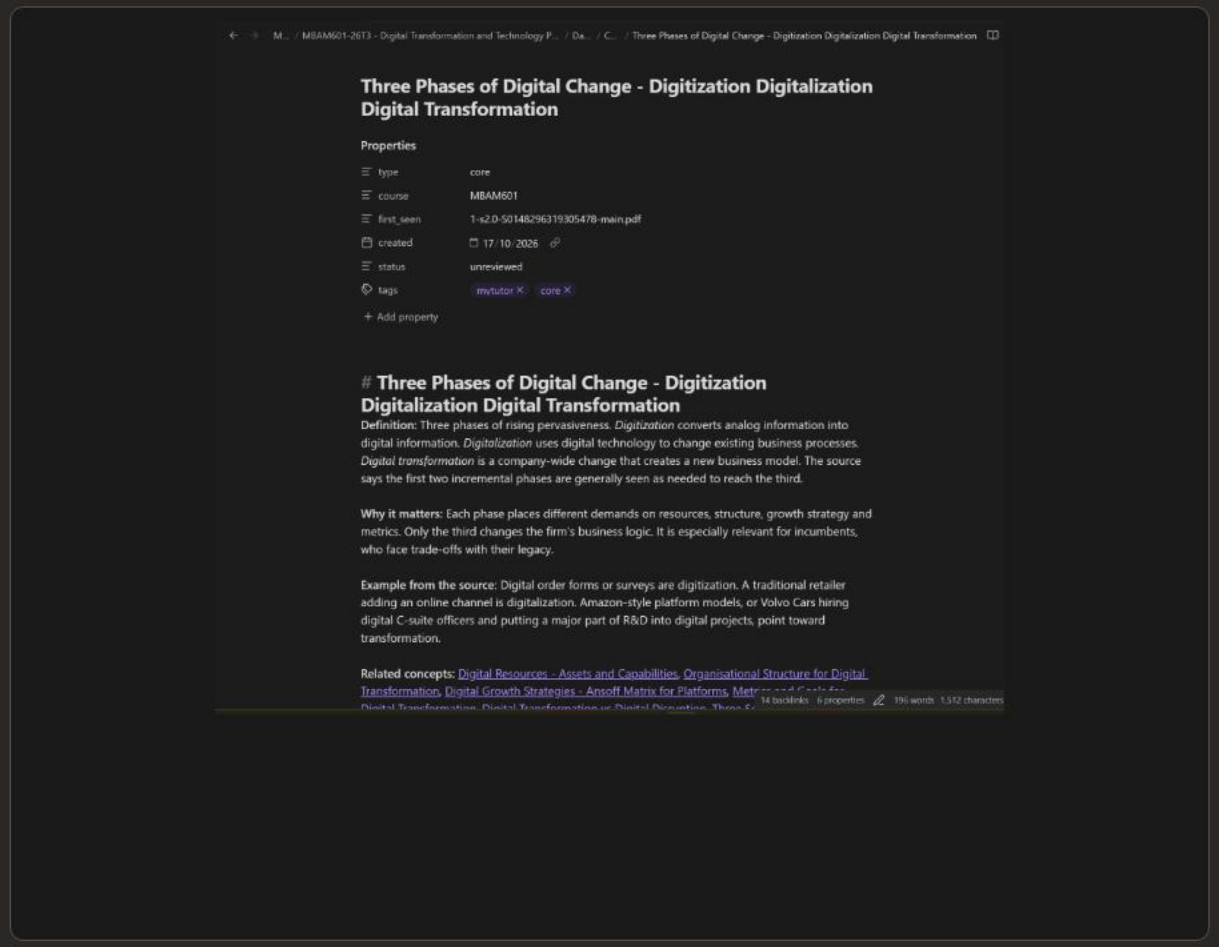
Via n8n, Days 2–6 and 10: 24 sources, 192 notes, US$2.68, 0 failures (runs I started) · Schedule: 100 unattended checks every 15 min, 25–27 Oct, 0 failures (run_log.csv)

CONSTRAINTS → MITIGATION

API cost → spending limit, logged per run · course files go to an AI service → own courses only, UC guidance · scanned PDFs → no OCR yet, reported · n8n down → Task Scheduler fall-back

OUTPUTS

ONE SOURCE BECOMES A WEB OF LINKED NOTES



DAY 1, REAL RUN

88 notes

from 10 sources, 34,255 words, in about 7 minutes of machine time, US$1.01. Workflow output; accuracy is sampled on slide 8.

WHERE THEY GO

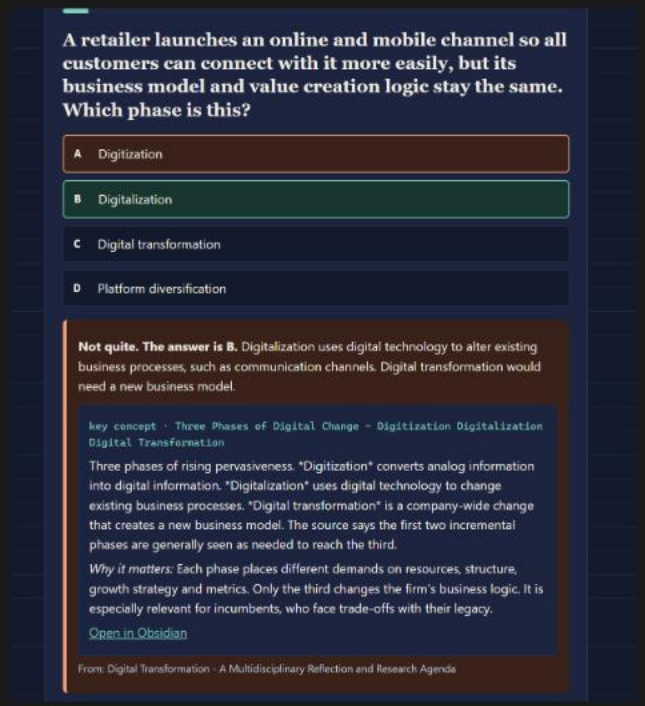
Ref 10, one per source, linked to the original PDF · Core 50 concepts · Cases 16 organisations · Quizzes 10 + a 20-question set

WHY IT MATTERS

myTutor is given every title already in the vault, so new notes link to old ones. This concept already has 14 backlinks.

PRACTICE LOOP

A WRONG ANSWER LEADS STRAIGHT BACK TO THE NOTE



1. **Wrong answer** shows the right one
2. **Why**, in plain words
3. **Key concept**: definition and why it matters
4. **One click** opens the note in my vault
5. **Score** copied to my recall log

RECALL, MEASURED ONCE

17 / 20

Day 9 set, from memory, 6 days after the notes (85%). Caveat: an AI review rated the quiz 72/100; weak wrong options mean some answers can be found by elimination, so 17/20 may overstate recall.

A fixed set of 20 questions per day, built once from my readings · works offline, no AI call while I practise

IMPACT

SAME FIVE FILES: 44.5 MINUTES BECAME 12.1

73%

less time on the same five files

KPI	Manual	myTutor	Change	Better
Total minutes, 5 files	44.5	**12.1**	**−73%**	lower
Minutes per 1,000 words (15,212 words)	2.92	**0.80**	**−73%**	lower
Links to existing notes per note	2.2	**3.6**	**+62%**	higher
Structural quality, all 5 checks	70% (21/30)	**100% (34/34)**	**+30 pts**	higher
Notes made	30	**34**	**+4**	—
API cost	—	**US$0.48**		

CALCULATION

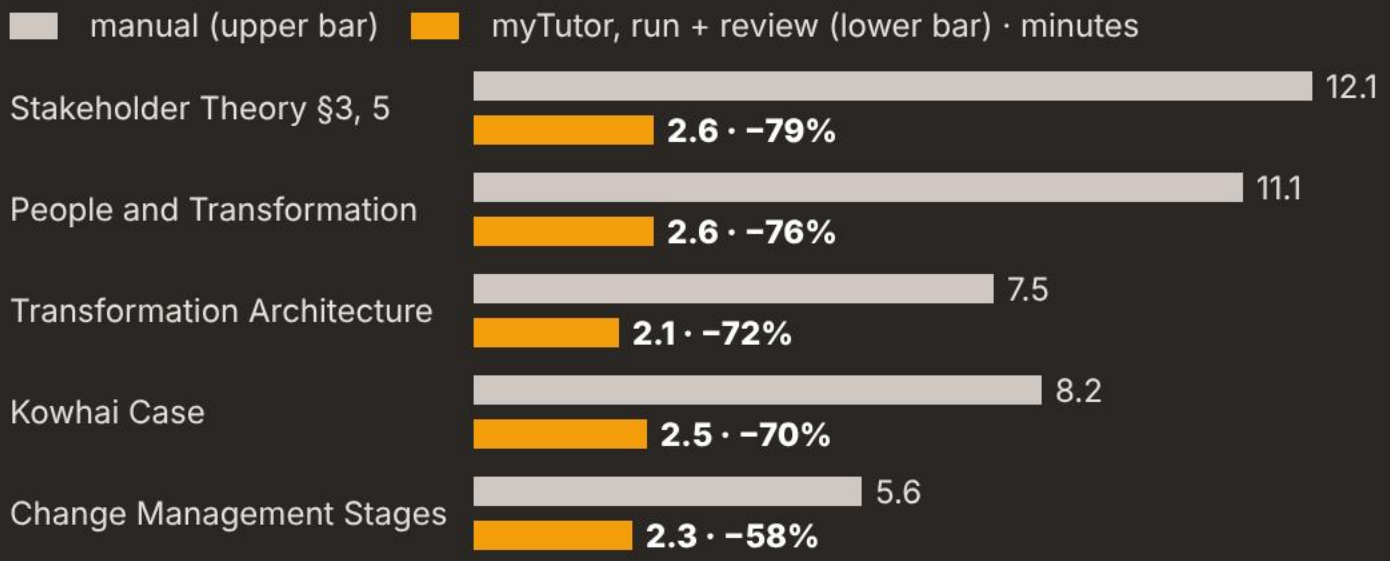
12.1 = 3.6 min generation (logged) + 8.5 min review (34 × 15 s, stopwatch average) · (12.1 − 44.5) ÷ 44.5 = −72.8% · with the whole 3.8-min run: 12.3 min, −72%

READ WITH CARE

The review is a light spot-check, not a full read. 3.6 min is machine time; my time is the 8.5 min review. Accuracy sample: 31 of 32 statements supported by the source.

ROBUSTNESS

EVERY FILE FASTER, EVEN WITH A SLOWER REVIEW



SENSITIVITY

Review at 30 s a note: 3.6 + 34 × 0.5 = 20.6 min, still −54%. myTutor stays faster unless review exceeds 1.2 min a note: (44.5 − 3.6) ÷ 34.

VALIDITY LIMITS

5 files, one tester, self-timed · manual run first, so I knew the content when reviewing · mixed lengths: the 350-word file gained least · accuracy: 31 of 32 statements in the 10 sampled notes match the source; 1 added an interpretation (AI-assisted check)

REFLECTION

WHAT WORKED, WHAT DIDN'T, AND HOW I'LL TEST THE FIXES

Finding	Cause	Change	Retest · by
No case note for the Kowhai case	prompt writes case notes only for real firms	add a teaching-case rule	5 teaching cases, all get a case note · 6 Nov
A whole book as one file gave 3–6 concepts	one call per file compresses long texts	split readings by section	full Stakeholder Theory PDF: concepts per section · 10 Nov
Accuracy sample: 31 of 32 statements supported; 1 added interpretation	prompt invites 'why it matters' commentary	mark interpretation as (my analysis)	re-audit Day 10 sample · 13 Nov
Recall 17/20 at 6 days, myTutor notes only	no manual-notes quiz to compare	same quiz on manual notes + transfer questions	compare scores on 2 days · 17 Nov
Quiz 72/100 (AI review); 11 of 20 answers B	weak distractors, no shuffling	shuffle options (done); better distractors	✓ retested: B 55% → 24% · distractors: 13 Nov
Live audit: 52 of 100 sampled notes link to an older note	quiz notes, and new topics with few older notes	prompt for related notes	re-audit next 3 teaching days · 20 Nov

WORKED

73% less time, 62% more links, US$0.48 · live: 192 notes over 6 days, 100 of 100 filed correctly

RISKS

Course files sent to an AI service: licences, UC guidance · no OCR · cost grows with volume · one tester

ADOPTION

Next: cohort classmates. Potential: a company brain for an SME or corporate, governance first